Soonho Kong

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Research Interests

My research focuses on agentic coding, where trust is the bottleneck to unlocking real productivity gains. I pursue a neurosymbolic approach that combines AI with automated and interactive theorem proving, so that coding agents can ship faster while delivering code with machine-checked correctness guarantees.

Work Experience

- Amazon Web Services (Sep 2021 – Present)
- Toyota Research Institute (Aug 2016 – Sep 2021)

Education

Carnegie Mellon University
Ph.D. in Computer Science
Advisor: Prof. Edmund M. Clarke

Seoul National University
Master of Science in Computer Science and Engineering
Advisor: Prof. Kwangkeun Yi

Seoul National University
Bachelor of Science in Computer Science and Engineering

Software

dReal: SMT solver for nonlinear theories over the Reals (Lead developer, since 2013)
Drake: Model-based design and verification for robotics (Platform-reviewer, 2017 – 2021)
Lean: Lean theorem prover (Contributor, 2013 – 2016)

Publications

[1] Mantas Baksys, Stefan Zetzsche, Olivier Bouissou, Remi Delmas, Soonho Kong, and Sean B. Holden. "ATLAS: Automated Toolkit for Large-Scale Verified Code Synthesis". In: *Deep Learning for Code (DL4C) Workshop at ICML 2026*. 2026. URL: https://popl26.sigplan.org/details/dafny-2026-papers/7/ATLAS-Automated-Toolkit-for-Large-Scale-Verified-Code-Synthesis.

[2] Jonas Bayer, Stefan Zetzsche, Olivier Bouissou, Remi Delmas, Michael Tautschnig, and Soonho Kong. "Teaching LLMs Program Semantics via Symbolic Execution Traces". In: *Deep Learning for Code (DL4C) Workshop at ICML 2026*. 2026. URL: https://arxiv.org/abs/2605.06184.

[3] Hojae Han, Jongyoon Kim, Sanghyeok Park, Dongwook Cheon, Yeachan Park, Myung Jae Jeon, Sunjong Choe, Soonho Kong, Wonseok Hur, Seung-won Hwang, and Donghoon Hyeon. "ShadowBench: Toward Reliable Automatic Evaluation of Semantic Alignment in Autoformalization". In: *EMNLP 2026*. 2026. URL: https://arxiv.org/abs/2608.29270.

[4] Jialin Lu, Soonho Kong, Rodrigo Stehling, Kaiyu Yang, Zhangyang Wang, Weiran Sun, and Wuyang Chen. "Lean Refactor: Multi-Objective Controllable Proof Optimization via Agentic Strategy Search". In: *NeurIPS 2026*. To appear. Project page: https://leanrefactor.github.io/. 2026. URL: https://arxiv.org/abs/2605.20244.

[5] Balaji Rao, John Harrison, Soonho Kong, Juneyoung Lee, and Carlo Lipizzi. "s2n-bignum-bench: A practical benchmark for evaluating low-level code reasoning of LLMs". In: *NeurIPS 2026*. To appear. 2026. URL: https://arxiv.org/abs/2603.14628.

[6] Chloe H. Su, Zhe Ye, Samuel Tenka, Aidan Yang, Soonho Kong, and Udaya Ghai. "Learning Adaptive LLM Decoding". In: *AdaptFM Workshop at ICML 2026*. 2026. URL: https://arxiv.org/abs/2603.09065.

[7] Zhe Ye, Udaya Ghai, Zhizhen Qin, Dawn Song, and Soonho Kong. "Agentic Verified Optimization of Real-World Software". In: *arXiv preprint* (2026). URL: https://arxiv.org/abs/2610.30188.

[8] Zhe Ye, Hantao Lou, Yuechun Sun, Peiyang Song, Zhengxu Yan, Timothe Kasriel, Qingyang Zhang, Kaiyu Yang, Soonho Kong, Jingxuan He, and Dawn Song. "Vero: Can AI Agents Build Formally Verified Software Repositories?" In: *NeurIPS 2026*. To appear. 2026. URL: https://arxiv.org/abs/2608.13522.

[9] Zhe Ye, Aidan Z.H. Yang, Huangyuan Su, Zhenyu Liao, Samuel Tenka, Zhizhen Qin, Udaya Ghai, Dawn Song, and Soonho Kong. "Intent-aligned Formal Specification Synthesis via Traceable Refinement". In: *AI4Math Workshop at ICML 2026*. Project page: https://spec.zhe.sh/. 2026. URL: https://arxiv.org/abs/2604.10392.

[10] Chenyang An, Zhizhen Qin, Soonho Kong, and Cedric Flamant. "DeRL: Diverse-Exploration Reinforcement Learning for Large Language Models Improves Mathematical Reasoning". In: *arXiv preprint* (2025). URL: https://openreview.net/forum?id=ZIYYeTkZQ4.

[11] Joseph Rotella, Zhizhen Qin, Aidan Z.H. Yang, Brando Miranda, Mohamed El Amine Seddik, Jingwei Zuo, Hakim Hacid, Leonardo de Moura, Soonho Kong, and Shi Hu. "Synthetic Theorem Generation in Lean". In: *arXiv preprint* (2025). URL: https://openreview.net/forum?id=EeDSMy5Ruj.

[12] Kevin Lotz, Amit Goel, Bruno Dutertre, Benjamin Kiesl-Reiter, Soonho Kong, and Dirk Nowotka. "Solving string constraints with concatenation using SAT". In: *FM-CAD 2024*. 2024. URL: https://www.amazon.science/publications/solving-string-constraints-with-concatenation-using-sat.

[13] Kevin Lotz, Amit Goel, Bruno Dutertre, Benjamin Kiesl-Reiter, Soonho Kong, Rupak Majumdar, and Dirk Nowotka. "Solving String Constraints Using SAT". In: *Computer Aided Verification*. Ed. by Constantin Enea and Akash Lal. Cham: Springer Nature Switzerland, 2023, pp. 187–208. URL: https://www.amazon.science/publications/solving-string-constraints-using-sat.

[14] U. Guajardo, A. Bryan, N. Arechiga, S. Campos, J. Chow, D. Jackson, S. Kong, G. Litt, and J. Pollock. "Certified Perception for Autonomous Cars". In: *6th Workshop On Monitoring And Testing Of Cyber-Physical Systems* (2021). URL: https://par.nsf.gov/servlets/purl/10272149.

[15] Daniel Jackson, Valerie Richmond, Mike Wang, Jeff Chow, Uriel Guajardo, Soonho Kong, Sergio Campos, Geoffrey Litt, and Nikos Arechiga. "Certified Control: An Architecture for Verifiable Safety of Autonomous Vehicles". In: *arXiv preprint arXiv:2104.06178* (2021). URL: https://arxiv.org/abs/2104.06178.

[16] Nikos Arechiga, Jonathan DeCastro, Soonho Kong, and Karen Leung. "Better AI through Logical Scaffolding". In: *FoMLAS 2019: 2nd Workshop on Formal Methods for ML-Enabled Autonomous Systems*. 2019. URL: https://arxiv.org/pdf/1909.06965.

[17] Sicun Gao, James Kapinski, Jyotirmoy Deshmukh, Nima Roohi, Armando Solar-Lezama, Nikos Arechiga, and Soonho Kong. "Numerically-Robust Inductive Proof Rules for Continuous Dynamical Systems". In: *Computer Aided Verification*. Ed. by Isil Dillig and Serdar Tasiran. Cham: Springer International Publishing, 2019, pp. 137–154. URL: https://link.springer.com/content/pdf/10.1007/978-3-030-25543-5_9.pdf.

[18] Calvin Huang, Soonho Kong, Sicun Gao, and Damien Zufferey. "Evaluating Branching Heuristics in Interval Constraint Propagation for Satisfiability". In: *Numerical Software Verification*. Ed. by Majid Zamani and Damien Zufferey. Cham: Springer International Publishing, 2019, pp. 85–100. URL: https://link.springer.com/chapter/10.1007/978-3-030-28423-7_6.

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[20] Jeevana Priya Inala, Sicun Gao, Soonho Kong, and Armando Solar-Lezama. "REAS: Combining Numerical Optimization with SAT Solving". In: *arXiv preprint arXiv:1802.04408* (2018). URL: https://arxiv.org/abs/1802.04408.

[21] Soonho Kong, Armando Solar-Lezama, and Sicun Gao. "Delta-Decision Procedures for Exists-Forall Problems over the Reals". In: *Computer Aided Verification*. Ed. by Hana Chockler and Georg Weissenbacher. CAV'18. Cham: Springer International Publishing, 2018, pp. 219–235. URL: https://link.springer.com/content/pdf/10.1007/978-3-319-96142-2_15.pdf.

[22] Kyungmin Bae, Peter Csaba Ölveczky, Soonho Kong, Sicun Gao, and Edmund M. Clarke. "SMT-Based Analysis of Virtually Synchronous Distributed Hybrid Systems". In: *Hybrid Systems: Computation and Control*. HSCC'16. Vienna, Austria: ACM, 2016, pp. 145–154. URL: http://doi.acm.org/10.1145/2883817.2883849.

[23] Md. Ariful Islam, Greg Byrne, Soonho Kong, Edmund M. Clarke, Rance Cleaveland, Flavio H. Fenton, Radu Grosu, Paul L. Jones, and Scott A. Smolka. "Bifurcation Analysis of Cardiac Alternans Using delta-Decidability". In: *Computational Methods in Systems Biology*. Ed. by Ezio Bartocci, Pietro Lio, and Nicola Paoletti. CMSB'16. Cham: Springer International Publishing, 2016, pp. 132–146.

[24] Seunghak Lee, Soonho Kong, and Eric P. Xing. "A network-driven approach for genome-wide association mapping". In: *Bioinformatics* 32.12 (2016), pp. i164–i173. URL: http://dx.doi.org/10.1093/bioinformatics/btw270.

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[26] Soonho Kong, Sicun Gao, Wei Chen, and Edmund Clarke. "dReach: Delta-Reachability Analysis for Hybrid Systems". In: *Tools and Algorithms for the Construction and Analysis of Systems*. TACAS'15. New York, NY, USA: Springer-Verlag New York, Inc., 2015, pp. 200–205. URL: https://doi.org/10.1007/978-3-662-46681-0_15.

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[29] Qinsi Wang, Paolo Zuliani, Soonho Kong, Sicun Gao, and Edmund M. Clarke. "SReach: A Probabilistic Bounded Delta-Reachability Analyzer for Stochastic Hybrid Systems". In: *Computational Methods in Systems Biology*. Ed. by Olivier Roux and Jérémie Bourdon. CMSB'15. Cham: Springer International Publishing, 2015, pp. 15–27.

[30] Sicun Gao, Soonho Kong, and Edmund M. Clarke. "Proof Generation from Delta-Decisions". In: *Symbolic and Numeric Algorithms for Scientific Computing*. SYNASC'14. Sept. 2014, pp. 156–163.

[31] Bing Liu, Soonho Kong, Sicun Gao, Paolo Zuliani, and Edmund M. Clarke. "Parameter Synthesis for Cardiac Cell Hybrid Models Using δ-Decisions". In: *Computational Methods in Systems Biology*. Ed. by Pedro Mendes, Joseph O. Dada, and Kieran Smallbone. CMSB'14. Cham: Springer International Publishing, 2014, pp. 99–113.

[32] Sagar Chaki, Arie Gurfinkel, Soonho Kong, and Ofer Strichman. "Compositional Sequentialization of Periodic Programs". In: *Verification, Model Checking, and Abstract Interpretation*. VMCAI'13. Rome, Italy: Springer-Verlag New York, Inc., 2013, pp. 536–554. URL: http://dx.doi.org/10.1007/978-3-642-35873-9_31.

[33] Sicun Gao, Soonho Kong, and Edmund M. Clarke. "dReal: An SMT Solver for Nonlinear Theories over the Reals". In: *Automated Deduction*. CADE'13. Lake Placid, NY: Springer-Verlag, 2013, pp. 208–214. URL: http://dx.doi.org/10.1007/978-3-642-38574-2_14.

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[35] Yungbum Jung, Soonho Kong, Bow-Yaw Wang, and Kwangkeun Yi. "Deriving Invariants by Algorithmic Learning, Decision Procedures, and Predicate Abstraction". In: *Verification, Model Checking, and Abstract Interpretation*. VMCAI'10. Madrid, Spain: Springer-Verlag, 2010, pp. 180–196. URL: http://dx.doi.org/10.1007/978-3-642-11319-2_15.

[36] Soonho Kong, Yungbum Jung, Cristina David, Bow-Yaw Wang, and Kwangkeun Yi. "Automatically Inferring Quantified Loop Invariants by Algorithmic Learning from Simple Templates". In: *Asian Conference on Programming Languages and Systems*. APLAS'10. Shanghai, China: Springer-Verlag, 2010, pp. 328–343. URL: http://dl.acm.org/citation.cfm?id=1947873.1947904.

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Patents

[1] "Verification of neural network model evolution". Ahmed Irfan, Homer Strong, Soon Ho Kong, Atiye Alaeddini, and Aleksandar Nevenov Chakarov United States Patent #12694298. July 2026.

[2] "Systems and methods for automatically generating solver code for nonlinear model predictive control solvers". Sarah Koehler, Soonho Kong, Frank Permenter, Kevin Zaseck, and Avinash Balachandran United States Patent #12208809. January 2025.

[3] "Wearable exoskeleton". Jonathan DeCastro, Soon Ho Kong, Nikos Gonzalez Arechiga, Frank Permenter, and Dennis Park United States Patent #11918535. March 2024.

[4] "Actively adapting to driving environments based on human interactions". Soonho Kong, Jonathan DeCastro, Nikos Arechiga, and Frank Permenter United States Patent #11801852. October 2023.

[5] "Certified control for self-driving cars". Daniel Jackson, Jonathan Decastro, Soon Ho Kong, Nikos Arechiga Gonzalez, Dimitrios Koutentakis, Feng Ping Angela Leong, Mike Meichang Wang, And Xin Zhang United States Patent #11745732. September 2023.

[6] "Personalized notification system for mobility as a service". Soon Ho Kong, Jonathan DeCastro, Nikos Gonzalez Arechiga, and Frank Permenter United States Patent #11543258. January 2023.

[7] "Predictive impairment monitor system and method". Nikos Gonzalez Arechiga, Soon Ho Kong, Jonathan DeCastro, Frank Permenter, and Dennis Park United States Patent #11518408. December 2022.

[8] "Predictive parking due to weather". Nikos Gonzalez Arechiga, Soon Ho Kong, Jonathan DeCastro, Frank Permenter, and Dennis Park United States Patent #11479239. October 2022.

[9] "Simulation-based Technique to Synthesize Controllers that Satisfy Signal Temporal Logic Specifications". Nikos Arechiga, Karen Y. Leung, Soon Ho Kong, Jonathan Decastro, and Frank Permenter United States Patent #11256611. February 2022.

[10] "System and Method for Detecting Errors and Improving Reliability of Perception Systems Using Logical Scaffolds". Nikos Arechiga, Soonho Kong, Jonathan DeCastro, Sagar Behere, and Dennis Park United States Patent #11157756. October 2021.

[11] "Actively Adapting To Driving Environments Based On Human Interactions". Soonho Kong, Jonathan DeCastro, Nikos Arechiga, and Frank Permenter United States Patent #11072342. July 2021.

[12] “Systems And Methods For Improving Situational Awareness Of A User”. Jonathan DeCastro, Frank Permenter, Soonho Kong, and Nikos Arechiga United States Patent #10621858. April 2020.

Professional Activities

Workshop Organizer:
VeriCodeGen 2026: AI for Verifiable Coding @NeurIPS 2026
AI for Math 2026: 3rd AI for Math Workshop @ICML 2026
MATH-AI 2025: 5th Workshop on Mathematical Reasoning and AI @NeurIPS 2025
AI for Math 2025: 2nd AI for Math Workshop @ICML 2025

Program Committee Member:
ADHS 2021, HSCC 2021, MEMOCODE 2021, MT-CPS 2021, HSCC 2020, MEMOCODE 2020, DARS 2019, HSCC 2019, MEMOCODE 2019, NSV 2019, DARS 2018, WSC 2018

External Reviewer:
IEEE-IV 2021, IEEE-IV 2020, POPL 2020, ATVA 2015, ASE 2014, FoSSaCS 2013, POPL 2013, APLAS 2012, SAS 2012, GPCE 2010, SPLASH 2010, CAV 2010, VMCAI 2010, SAS 2009, DEFECTS 2009, APLAS 2007

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